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Principal Developer

Home Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 3rd August 2026



Home Office

Reference number

471736

Salary

£76,879

New entrants to the Civil Service will start their role on the salary band minimum £76,879 for National roles and salary band minimum £80,879 for London roles.

You may be eligible for an additional non-pensionable allowance, pending a Capability and Skills Assessment, with a value of up to £18,721.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

HO - Home Office Digital

Type of role

Digital
Engineering
Information Technology

Working pattern

Full-time, Part-time, Compressed hours, Shift working

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Croydon, Salford, Sheffield, Westminster

About the job

Job summary

This role sits in the Common Business Application (CBA) team, which is a critical capability within UK border protection, and part of a comprehensive RN detection capability within the Cyclamen programme, which screens incoming freight, vehicles and passengers for such material, in order to protect the public.

This sits within the Shared Applications Service department, with over 650 engineers. This is the engineering capability, developing in all areas including policing, Homeland Security, Border Force, and migration.

Our work spans Home Office mission-critical operations, such as enhancing Counter-Terrorism capabilities, transforming Border Security and immigration processes, to revolutionising asylum case management and enhancing Counter-Terrorism capabilities. Imagine developing technology that helps reunite families, creates safer communities, protects vulnerable people, and ensures smoother journeys for the millions travelling to and from the UK.

Where business needs allow, some roles may be suitable for a combination of office and home-based working. Where this is the case, employees will be expected to spend a minimum of **60% of their working time in the office**.

Applicants can raise any queries to the email address at the bottom of the advert.

Watch this short video to hear from members of Home Office Digital talking about the projects they work on and their experience of working here: [Working for Home Office Digital](#).

Job description

The Principal Developer works on challenging technical problems, which require broad thinking while remaining hands-on developing software. You will be expected to actively deliver but will have more of a focus on ensuring delivery quality and overall service value. You will be working on large scale problems on critical services setting strategy and standards for the wider team to follow

You may be called upon to take part in planning with senior stakeholders to make sure that technical designs match strategy. In this you will be expected to help ensure that all engineers, architects and other professions are working together. You will also identify, test and advocate for new tools or approaches.

You will support the assurance of our solutions and help resolve any discrepancy between approach and organisational strategy.

As a Principal Developer, you will be expected to mentor other senior engineers in technical tasks, as well as support recruitment and assessment activities, as well as leading engineering teams directly.

You will be expected to understand and use the latest AWS technology, service integration designs, tools and techniques, as well as applying Secure by Design Principles.

Tools and Technologies we use:

We are keen for Engineers to continue learning new technologies, we have a large range in the Home Office but would especially welcome applications from candidates with experience in the below:

Java (Current Versions), Spring, Spring Boot, Maven, JavaScript

Other Languages used across the

service include: Databases, PostgreSQL and Mongo, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm React, Node.js, Apache Nifi.

Person specification

Main Responsibilities

Carrying out challenging implementation tasks, whilst maintaining strong stakeholder engagement and keeping the relevant documentation up to date.

Delivering new designs and implementations, working with architects/ security and other stakeholders.

Pioneering new software architectural and build/integration approaches, ensuring they adhere to organisational strategy.

Implementing effective test and QA across a number of individuals/ systems.

Being the technical authority in your area, providing arbitration for complex technical decisions.

To act or become a Generalizing Specialist, with deep knowledge in their domain, but also broad working understanding of other system areas.

Be able to support the live 24/7 service as required.

Working Pattern

This role is available on a full-time basis with the option of [compressed hours](#) working. This role is also suitable for [part-time](#) working hours, with a minimum requirement to work 30 hours per week due to business requirements.

Essential Skills

Design, specification, development of large and complex data platforms, both cloud and on-premises, including platform migration. (SWDN)

Selecting appropriate tooling, and specifying, designing, building, refactoring, and documenting complex code, scripts, frameworks, and infrastructure-as-code definitions, to automate build and deployment activities. (PROG)

Specify and lead the implementation of master data management processes and standards, ensuring data integrity, transformation, availability and searchability through formal methods and protection measures. (DATM)

Specifying and setting standards for automated testing, scanning and code analysis in collaboration with testers, architects, service owners and developers. (TEST)

Specifying, guiding, and leading the adoption of automation frameworks for CI/CD and ETL data pipelines. (SINT)

Specifying and ensuring good use of processes, procedures and tooling for application or database monitoring, maintenance, and incident response. (ASUP)

SFIA capability framework

Skills for the Information Age (SFIA) version 8 is the technical framework that sets the standard capability and development of all levels in the Home Office. This is a link to the capability framework: [All skills A - Z English \(sfia-online.org\)](https://sfia-online.org).

We use set SFIA technical skills to form our interview questions and we will assess you against these technical skills during the selection process.

The essential skills listed above are reflective of the Home Office Government Digital and Data Profession Career Framework (based on the industry standard SFIA framework). Use the SFIA [Levels of responsibility](#) to understand what would be expected for each technical skills listed below.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Managing a Quality Service

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Software design (SWDN) - Level 5

Programming/software development (PROG) - Level 4

Testing (TEST) - Level 4

Systems integration and build (SINT) - Level 5

Data management (DATM) - Level 4

Application support (ASUP) - Level 4

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £76,879, Home Office contributes £22,271 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme.

[Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Why work for us...

Find out more information at: [Benefits - Home Office Careers](#), but some of the primary ones are:

A Civil Service Pension with employer contribution rates of at least 28.97%.

In-year reward scheme for one-off or sustained exceptional personal or team achievements.

25 days annual leave on appointment, rising with service.

8 days of public holidays, plus 1 additional privilege day.

Where business needs allow, some roles may be suitable for a combination of office and home-based working. This is a non-contractual arrangement where all employees will be expected to spend a minimum of 60% of their working time in an office.

[Sign-up on our website](#) to receive emails with information about careers at the Home Office.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

As part of the application process, you will be asked to complete a CV and 1000 word personal statement:

1. **CV** include a brief employment history outlining for each role, the organisation, job title, dates in post, and key responsibilities and achievements. Any recent employment gaps should be explained. A second section should set out the skills and experience most relevant to this role, drawing on your career, training, and other relevant activities without repeating the employment history. Focus on the evidence that best demonstrates your capability to meet the role requirements.
2. **Personal statement** - this should present a clear and coherent narrative explaining why you are applying, what you would bring to the role, and how your experience meets the essential criteria. Use well-chosen examples to illustrate your impact, drawing on [STAR](#)-style thinking where helpful, but ensure the statement reads as a single, flowing document rather than a set of isolated responses.

To ensure you are assessed on merit alone, we ask you to anonymise your application. This means removing personal identifiers such as your name,

age, and place of education. You do not need to remove your employment history, job titles, or any information about your work.

Watch our three short videos on how to apply for our roles: [Applying - Home Office Careers](#).

Problems during the application process

If you experience problems accessing this advert, or you think you've made a mistake on an initial application, please contact hocandidates.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk, including the vacancy reference, at least two working days before the vacancy closes. Further information can be found [on our website](#).

Do not create or attempt to submit another application, online test or use a different Civil Service Jobs account to proceed as this would be in violation of the candidate declaration.

Sift Stage

The sift will be held on the **CV and Personal Statement**. Please read the essential skills for this position carefully. We will only consider those who meet the listed requirements.

In the event of a high number of applications received, an initial sift may be held on the **Personal Statement**.

Interview Stage

Candidates reaching the required standard will then be invited to attend an interview. The interview will assess your **Technical Skills (SFIA Framework) and Behaviours** using **technical and behaviour-based** questions.

At the beginning of the interview, you will be assessed on your technical capability through a technical problem-solving exercise. We will provide you with the information in the interview and you will be asked to share your screen with the panel, so you can point out various aspects.

If you are invited to an interview, you will be required to bring a range of documentation for the purposes of establishing identity and to aid any pre-

employment checks. Please see the attached list of Home Office acceptable ID documents.

Sift and Interview dates

The sift will commence from **04/08/2026**.

Interviews are expected to take place from **20/08/2026**. (Subject to the Panel's operational requirements/priorities).

Interviews will be conducted remotely via MS Teams.

We will try to meet the dates set out in the advert. There may be occasions when these dates will change. You will be provided with sufficient notice of the confirmed dates.

Further information

If you have previously made an unsuccessful application for a role with the same essential skills and are not able to demonstrate how you have developed these skills since your last application, please reconsider applying as your application is unlikely to be successful.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service on your behalf. However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms directly. If you are doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

Reserve List

A reserve list of successful candidates will be kept for 12 months. Should another role become available within that period you may be offered this position.

Reserve lists may be held for each location. Candidates will be appointed in merit order by location where this applies.

Similar Roles

Job offers to this post are made based on merit. We often have **similar roles** available at different grades. If a candidate is suitable for a similar role or a lower grade than they have applied for, we may offer the candidate that role without the need to go through a further selection process providing the role has the same competencies and essential skills.

UK residency and security requirements

For meaningful security checks to be carried out, individuals need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time. Learn more on our website. [Security Checks - Home Office Careers](#).

Please note that this role requires Security Check (SC) clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years.

However, in exceptional circumstances security clearance applications for candidates who have been present in the UK for at least 3 of the last 5 years may be considered. Failure to meet this residency requirement will result in your security clearance application being rejected.

Candidates must also hold or be prepared to undergo [Non-Police Personnel Vetting Level 3 \(NPPV3\)](#).

For further information on National Security Vetting please visit the following page [Demystifying Vetting - GOV.UK](#).

Visa Sponsorship

We are unable to sponsor any individuals via Skilled Worker Sponsorship / Tier 2 (General) work visas as we do not hold a UK Visa & Immigration (UKVI) Skilled Worker License.

Capability allowance

The advertised role is part of the Home Office Government Digital and Data Profession. This role has access to a digital capability-based allowance. Applicants who are successful at interview will be invited to complete a Capability and Skills Assessment post-interview. Any allowance awarded will

be based on the assessment of your capability against the six skills advertised for this role. Please see the [Home Office Pay Framework Allowance Careers](#) page for more information.

The allowance values are set by the Home Office, subject to remaining in a qualifying role. This allowance is non-contractual, subject to an annual review and could be withdrawn at any time.

For both new entrants and existing civil servants, the total compensation offer is a combination of base salary and, if applicable, a capability-based allowance. The pay ranges for this role are National: £76,879 - £84,567 and London: £80,879 - £88,967. New entrants to the Civil Service will start on the pay range minimum. For existing civil servants, our policies on [level transfer](#) and [promotion](#) will apply.

Reasonable Adjustments

If a person with disabilities is at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service via HOfrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance Required section in the Additional Requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you are deaf, a language service professional.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the Contact point for applicants section.

Feedback

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : AC Recruitment

Email : ACRecruitment@homeoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : HOfrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel that your application has not been treated in accordance with the Civil Service Recruitment Principles, and you wish to make a complaint, then contact the Government Recruitment Service via HOrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response that you receive, then you can contact the Civil Service Commission.

